WEEKLY CURRENT AFFAIRS RETROSPECTIVE: PART 1

Key Diplomatic, Geopolitical, National & Scientific Developments

1. GEOPOLITICS, DEFENCE & BILATERAL AGREEMENTS

- **Nobel Peace Prize Distinction:** South African-born human rights defender of Indian origin, **Navanethem (Navi) Pillay**, received global recognition. In Indian history, Kailash Satyarthi was honored with the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014.
- **Chinese Military Footprint in SE Asia:** China accelerated construction of a new strategic surveillance and naval access outpost in **Laos** (a landlocked ASEAN nation situated in Southeast Asia).
- **Shinzo Abe Memorial in Varanasi:** Inaugurated by Akie Abe (widow of former Japanese PM Shinzo Abe). Abe was conferred India's second-highest civilian honor, the *Padma Vibhushan* (2021).
- **Israel Presidential Honor:** Conferred upon **Smith Macher** for distinguished state contributions.
- **India-Switzerland Migration Pact:** India formalized a bilateral Mobility and Migration Partnership Agreement with Switzerland. Concurrently, high-value Kashmiri walnuts and artisanal shawls were presented to Swiss state dignitaries.
- **Al-Amin Joint Declaration (Oct 4):** Multilateral maritime and governance accord governing the Red Sea littoral corridor signed by **Egypt, Eritrea, Somalia, and Sudan**. Key focus: strategic security along the Nile River system (confluence of the White Nile and Blue Nile).

2. NATIONAL POLICIES, INFRASTRUCTURE & GOVERNANCE

- **Nameri Tiger Reserve Approved by CAETS:** Nameri National Park in Assam received accreditation under the international Conservation Assured | Tiger Standards (CAETS).
- **Constitutional Law in the News:** Significant public debate around *Article 20* (protection in respect of conviction) and *Article 22* (protection against arrest and preventive detention vs. punitive arrest).
- **Noida International Airport Naming:** The greenfield international aviation hub in Jewar (Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh) continues development alongside terminals at Lucknow (CCSIA) and Varanasi (LBSI Airport).
- **Sagar Manthan 3rd Edition:** The high-level national maritime governance summit was held in New Delhi (the maiden edition was inaugurated in 2024).
- **National Coastal Mission 2.0:** Officially unveiled in New Delhi by Union Minister of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, **Bhupender Yadav**.
- **Bhadohi District Renaming:** Carved out of Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, Bhadohi is designated as **Sant Ravidas Nagar**.

3. BANKING, CORPORATE & SCIENTIFIC MILESTONES

- **Highest-Compensated Indian Banking CEO:** Anup Bagchi of ICICI Securities / senior private banking leadership.
- **H-1B Visa & Green Card Scrutiny:** Strict immigration updates impacted major IT firms: Microsoft, Infosys, TCS, Wipro, and Cognizant.
- **WASH Bonds Issued:** Specialized Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) institutional finance bonds floated by **Nabkisan Finance**.
- **National Household Travel Survey:** First-of-its-kind baseline survey data compiled and released by the **National Statistical Office (NSO)** under MoSPI.
- **Judicial Appointments:** Three High Court Chief Justices were elevated simultaneously as Judges of the Supreme Court of India.
- **Herpetological Discovery:** A distinct morph of the *Olive Green Snake* was documented in the Biligirirangana (BR) Hills, Karnataka.

4. ENVIRONMENT, WILDLIFE & CONSERVATION LEDGERS

- **Project Cheetah Population Growth:** The cheetah count across release sites (Kuno, Gandhi Sagar, and newly designated Nauradehi / Veerangana Durgavati Sanctuary in MP) marked upward trajectories. Total cubs and adults increased with 6 recent additions.
- **WWF Living Planet Report 2026:** Highlighted a staggering **73% average decline** in monitored global wildlife vertebrate populations over the past 50 years.
- **National Wildlife Week (Oct 2–8):** Observed across India to reinforce conservation awareness.
- **Maldhari Community Relocation:** The Gujarat government allocated financial packages (₹15 lakh per family) to relocate the indigenous Maldhari pastoralists from **Barda Wildlife Sanctuary**, establishing it as the second home for Asiatic lions alongside Gir National Park.
- **India's Maiden High-Altitude Snow Leopard Safari:** Established in the Union Territory of **Ladakh**.

5. SCIENCE, SPACE & NOBEL PRIZES BREAKDOWN

Field	Laureates / Mnemonic	Core Discovery / Field
Physiology / Medicine	N, D, and H ("NDH" Framework)	MicroRNA regulation & post-transcriptional gene expression
Physics	Hopfield & Geoffrey Hinton / "PF" (Physics-Francis)	Foundational discoveries in artificial neural networks & machine learning
Chemistry	David Baker, Demis Hassabis, John Jumper / "CSK" (Kagan & Soy)	Computational protein design & protein structure prediction (molecular mirrors)
Literature	Annie Ernaux / Canadian-focused themes	Courage and clinical acuity of collective personal memory
Ramanujan Prize	**Prof. Mahesh Kakde** (IISc Bengaluru)	Non-commutative Iwasawa theory and algebraic number theory

6. SPORTS, SUMMIT REGISTERS & DEFENCE DRILLS

- **BRICS Traditional Indigenous Games:** Hosted at the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex, Ahmedabad, Gujarat. Official Mascot: *Saathi*.
- **19th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD):** Next session scheduled for 2027 in Kolkata, West Bengal (2025 edition held in Bhubaneswar, Odisha).
- **153rd Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU) Assembly:** Held in Tanzania; the Indian parliamentary delegation was led by Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman, **Harivansh Narayan Singh**.
- **Asian Games 2030 Hosting Rights:** Re-allocated to **Doha, Qatar**. Meanwhile, the 20th Asian Games (Aichi-Nagoya, Japan) saw India secure 85 medals (21 Gold).
- **Military Exercises:** *Ex Mountain Guardian* held in Uttarakhand between Indian Army and UAE Armed Forces. *Ex SARREX* (multinational maritime search and rescue) conducted off Paradip, Odisha.
- **Missile Tests:** Pakistan test-fired *Fatah-4* guided artillery cruise rocket; France test-launched its submarine-launched ballistic missile *M51.3*.

7. APPOINTMENTS, ECONOMY & CULTURE

Monetary Policy: RBI MPC under Governor Sanjay Malhotra held/calibrated repo rate at 5.5%. **IAF Leadership:** Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit assumed office as Vice Chief / 29th Chief of Air Staff (distinguished for Operation Safed Sagar). **Obituary:** Legendary cinema artist Sadashiv Amrapurkar / Nana Patekar's debut film reference: *Gaman*. **Public Health:** Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda spearheaded the "JOSH" nationwide TB-elimination campaign.

1. NEPAL INUNDATION: THE BUDHI GANDAKI RIVER CRISIS

Continuous cloudbursts and glacial overflow across the Manaslu Himalayan slopes triggered cataclysmic flash floods in Nepal's Gorkha District, washing away six major vehicular suspension bridges. Prime Minister Balen Shah deployed the Nepalese Army, Police, and relief cadres.

- **Hydrological Profile:** The Budhi Gandaki originates along the eastern flanks of Mount Manaslu (8,163 m). It flows south through steep gorges, converging with the Trishuli River to form the **Narayani (Gandak) River**, which subsequently empties into the Ganges River near Patna, India.
- **Transboundary Impact:** Nepal is a landlocked buffer state bordering 5 Indian states: Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal, and Sikkim. Bilateral military training: *Ex Surya Kiran*. Headquarter of SAARC: Kathmandu.

2. UNCTAD TRADE & DEVELOPMENT REPORT

- **Report Publisher:** UNCTAD (Geneva-based; established 1964; maiden report issued 1981).
- **Global Trade Trends:** US and China experienced deceleration in bilateral trade shares.
- **Greenfield Surge:** India's greenfield investment outlays expanded by **7%**. Greenfield projects represent **5.7%** of total investments (vs China's 2.8%), focusing on Semiconductors, AI, and Green Energy Transition.

3. BATHUKAMMA FLORAL FESTIVAL

- **Geographical Identity:** Celebrated across **Telangana** and parts of Andhra Pradesh during Navratri (Bhadrapada Amavasya to Durgashtami).
- **Cultural Roots:** Traced to the Western Chalukya and Kakatiya dynasties. Women craft concentric floral pyramids (Bathukamma) using native blooms: Gunugu, Tangedu, and Marigold.
- **Connected Rituals:** Concludes with *Saddula Bathukamma* and precedes the *Boddemma* festival.

4. MARITIME INDUCTIONS: ICGS AJIT & INS MANGROL

- **ICGS Ajit:** 2nd Fast Patrol Vessel under the 8-ship *Adamya Class* built by **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)**. Commissioned at Okha, Gujarat on Oct 9, 2026. Equipped for coastal surveillance, interdiction, and HADR.
- **INS Mangrol:** Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) under the *Agray Class*, developed by **Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)**. Inducted at Mumbai on Oct 12. Integrated with indigenous **Maareech Advanced Torpedo Defence System**.

5. SOCIO-ECONOMIC SCHEMES, ENERGY & AGRO INNOVATIONS

- **Bhagini Nivedita Scheme (West Bengal):** ₹50,000 higher education financial grant for unmarried women across 3 installments (₹17k, ₹17k, ₹16k). Also enhanced *Karmabandhu* sanitation worker allowances from ₹5,000 to ₹8,000/month.
- **Project Seabird Phase IIA:** CDS inaugurated major expansion at **Karwar Naval Base**, Karnataka (operationalized 1986 under the Sagarmala infrastructure matrix).
- **Adani-Druk Green Hydel Joint Venture:** 770 MW *Chamkharchhu-I* Hydroelectric Project in Bhutan. Equity structure: 49% Adani Power, 51% Druk Green Power Corp on a Build-Own-Operate-Transfer (BOOT) framework.
- **IIT Ropar's "AVNI" Agri-App:** Digital agri-learning platform tailored to educate school children on sustainable agronomy and biodiversity under the theme "Grow with Nature".
- **GI Tag for Ambaji Temple 'Mohanthal':** Traditional gram flour and pure desi ghee prasadam of the ancient Arasur Ambaji Shaktipeeth, Gujarat, awarded Geographical Indication status.
- **India-NZ U-20 Rugby Series:** Inaugurated at the Rajgir International Sports Complex, Nalanda, Bihar (celebrating 100 years of bilateral athletic ties).

SARNATH ARCHAEOLOGICAL COMPLEX (VARANASI, UP)

UNESCO Tentative / 45th Inscribed World Heritage Cultural Site

1. HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & DHARMA CHAKRA PRAVARTANA

Sarnath (ancient *Mrigadava* or *Rishipatana*), situated 10 km northeast of Varanasi near the confluence of the Ganges and Varuna rivers, is revered as the sanctum where Gautama Buddha delivered his first sermon (the **Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta**) to his five former ascetic companions (the Panchavargiya monks) in 528 BCE. This seminal event, termed the *Turning of the Wheel of Law*, laid down the Four Noble Truths and the Noble Eightfold Path.

2. CORE STUPAS & STRUCTURES

- **Dhamek Stupa:** Massive cylindrical brick tower (height: 43.6 m, diameter: 28 m) built in 500 CE during the Gupta era over a 3rd-century BCE Ashokan foundation. Adorned with delicate Gupta stone carvings.
- **Chaukhandi Stupa:** Built in the 5th century CE to commemorate where Buddha met his disciples; modified in 1588 CE with an octagonal Mughal tower to celebrate Emperor Humayun's visit.
- **Mulagandhakuti Vihara:** Ruins mark the monastic chamber where Buddha spent his first rainy retreat (vassa).

3. ASHOKAN PILLAR & EXCAVATIONS

- **Lion Capital of Ashoka:** Polished Chunar sandstone pillar base with four Asiatic lions standing back-to-back. Adopted as the National Emblem of India on 26 January 1950.
- **Excavation History:** First scientifically excavated in 1834–1835 by **Sir Alexander Cunningham** (founding father of ASI). Later excavated by F.O. Oertel (1904–1905).
- **Jain Heritage:** Sarnath is also the birthplace of Shreyanshanatha, the 11th Jain Tirthankara.

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (12 OCT)

- **97th Constitutional Amendment (2011):** Accorded constitutional status and protection to Cooperative Societies (inserted Art. 19(1)(c), Art. 43B, and Part IXB).
- **Government of India Act 1935:** Established the three legislative lists (Federal, Provincial, and Concurrent), which influenced the 7th Schedule of the Constitution.
- **Agricultural Shifting Cultivation:** *Jhum* (Northeast India), *Koman / Pama Dabi* (Odisha), *Podu* (Andhra Pradesh), *Bewar / Dahiya* (Madhya Pradesh).
- **Pre-Monsoon Showers:** *Coffee Blossom / Cherry Blossom* in Karnataka-Kerala; *Mango Showers* across peninsular coasts; *Kalbaisakhi* in West Bengal.

1. BILATERAL DEFENCE: EXERCISE INDRA 2026 & INS SAHYADRI

The bilateral maritime exercise **INDRA 2026** between the Indian Navy and Russian Navy commenced at the Pacific Fleet Base in **Vladivostok, Russia**. Conducted in dual Harbour and Sea phases from October 13 to 18.

- **Participating Unit:** Stealth multi-role frigate **INS Sahyadri** (Shivalik-class), built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), deployed under Indian Navy's *Operation Mahasagar*.
- **Strategic Roots:** Ex INDRA was instituted in 2003 as a joint bi-service initiative, transitioning to tri-service drills. Key procurement linkages with Russia: Su-30MKI, MiG-29K, S-400 Triumf, and AK-203 rifles produced at Korwa, Amethi.

2. NOBEL MEMORIAL PRIZE IN ECONOMIC SCIENCES

- **Laureates: Robert Hall** (Stanford University) & **Michael Woodford** (Columbia University).
- **Research Focus:** Macroeconomic foundations, monetary policy transmission, inflation targeting, and fiscal policy stabilizers.
- **Historical Note:** Formally titled the *Sveriges Riksbank Prize* (instituted 1968, first awarded 1969 to Ragnar Frisch and Jan Tinbergen). Prize sum: 11–12 Million SEK.
- **Indian Laureates:** Amartya Sen (1998, Welfare Economics) and Abhijit Banerjee (2019, Experimental Poverty Alleviation).

3. 33RD NHRC FOUNDATION DAY & JUDICIAL HEALTH

- **NHRC Milestone:** Marked 33rd Foundation Day on Oct 12 (established Oct 12, 1993 under Protection of Human Rights Act). Led by Acting Chairperson / Justice V. Ramasubramanian. 2026 Session Theme: *"Water: The Nectar of Life"*.
- **Judicial Well-Being Committee:** CJI constituted a 5-member High-Powered Standing Committee chaired by **Justice K.V. Viswanathan** on World Mental Health Day (Oct 10, theme: *"Lived Experience Heard"*). Roots trace to the 2024 Nauru Judicial Declaration.

4. TEMPLE CERTIFICATION: AYODHYA RAM MANDIR 'EAT RIGHT PLACE OF WORSHIP'

- **FSSAI Quality Accreditation:** The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir at Ayodhya was awarded the coveted **Eat Right Place of Worship** certification (valid through Oct 10, 2028). The audits verify safe prasadam preparation, potable water, vendor hygiene, and waste minimization under the Food Safety and Standards Act 2006.
- **Architectural Profile:** Designed by the Sompura family in pristine Gurjara-Nagara style; sanctum sanctorum houses the 5-year-old child form of Ram Lalla carved by Mysuru sculptor **Arun Yogiraj**.

5. GOVERNANCE, INNOVATION INDICES & APPOINTMENTS

- **Deputy Election Commissioner:** Senior bureaucrat **Prakash Rajpurohit** appointed by the ACC through April 2030 (replacing Sanjay Kumar). CEC: Gyanesh Kumar; ECs: Dr. Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.
- **Global Innovation Index (GII) 2026 (WIPO):** India secured **38th rank** among 139 economies (up from 81st in 2015). Top 3: Switzerland (1st), Sweden (2nd), USA (3rd). China ranked 10th. India leads lower-middle-income economies.
- **NG-OPV 3rd Vessel 'Shreyas':** Launched by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata. Follows sister ships *Sanghamitra* and *Shruti*. Speed: 23 knots.
- **UNICEF Celebrity Advocate:** Indian Women's Cricket Captain **Smriti Mandhana** appointed on International Day of the Girl Child (Oct 11) for the campaign *#PromiseToChildren*.
- **Exercise Konkan 2026:** Bilateral naval exercise between Indian Navy (INS Trishul) and UK Royal Navy conducted off Plymouth, England.

SANCHI STUPA COMPLEX (RAISEN DISTRICT, MP)

UNESCO World Heritage Site (1989) • Featured on ₹200 Banknote

1. CONSTRUCTION, PATRONAGE & DYNASTY TRANSITIONS

The Great Stupa at Sanchi (Stupa No. 1) is one of India's oldest stone monuments. Commissioned by Mauryan Emperor **Ashoka the Great** in the 3rd century BCE over relics of Gautama Buddha. It was later vandalized by Pushyamitra Shunga (mid-2nd century BCE) and rebuilt/expanded by his son Agnimitra Shunga, who doubled its diameter and encased it in sandstone. During the Satavahana period (1st century BCE), four elaborately sculpted ceremonial gateways (*Toranas*) were added.

2. ARCHITECTURAL ANATOMY OF THE STUPA

- **Anda:** The hemispherical earthen mound encased in stone, symbolizing the vault of heaven and containing holy relics.
- **Harmika:** Square balcony-like railing perched atop the Anda, representing the sacred abode of the gods.
- **Chhatra & Yasti:** Central triple-tiered stone umbrella structure signifying the Three Jewels (Triratna): Buddha, Dharma, and Sangha.
- **Vedika:** Stone circumambulatory perimeter balustrade designed for devotional clockwise pradakshina.

3. TORANAS, JATAKA ART & DISCOVERY

- **Torana Gateways:** Four cardinal gateways carved with episodes from the *Jataka Tales*, the life of Buddha, and nature spirits (Yakshis/Shalabhanjikas). Early carvings represent Buddha purely via aniconic symbols (Footprints, Bodhi Tree, Wheel, Empty Throne).
- **Rediscovery:** Documented in 1818 by British cavalry officer **General Henry Taylor**. Restored systematically by Sir John Marshall (DG of ASI, 1912–1919).

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (13 OCT)

- **Plant Alkaloids & Sources:** Quinine (extracted from Cinchona bark, antimalarial), Morphine (Papaver somniferum / Opium poppy), Nicotine (Nicotiana tabacum), Caffeine (Coffea arabica seeds).
- **Investigative Bodies & Acts:** Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI, formed 1963 via Santhanam Committee), Enforcement Directorate (ED, formed 1956), Central Vigilance Commission (CVC, statutory act passed 2003).
- **Common Terms in Sports:** Grand Slam tournaments: Australian Open, French Open (Roland Garros), Wimbledon, US Open.
- **Indian Currency Iconography:** ₹10 (Konark Sun Temple), ₹20 (Ellora Caves), ₹50 (Hampi Chariot), ₹100 (Rani ki Vav), ₹200 (Sanchi Stupa), ₹500 (Red Fort).

1. TRILATERAL EXERCISE IBSAMAR IX: DEPLOYMENT OF INS TARKASH

The 9th edition of the trilateral naval exercise **IBSAMAR (India-Brazil-South Africa Maritime)** was conducted off Simon's Town near Cape Town, South Africa, commencing October 11, 2026 under the theme: *"Stronger Together Towards a Shared Future in the Maritime Domain"*.

- **Participating Warship:** Guided-missile stealth frigate **INS Tarkash** (Teg Class / Project 11356), manufactured at Yantar Shipyard, Kaliningrad, Russia.
- **Operational Mandate:** Enhance interoperability, tactical maritime interdiction operations (MIO), VBSS (Visit, Board, Search, and Seizure), and surface anti-air firing drills. Inaugural edition: 2008.

2. MOUNTAIN EXPEDITION: MOUNT MUKUT ASCENT

- **Ascent Team:** Elite mountaineering contingent of the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** under the campaign banner *"Tat Se Parvat"*.
- **Geographic Profile:** Mount Mukut (elevation: **7,045 m**) sits in the Garhwal Himalayas, Chamoli District, Uttarakhand, adjacent to Kamet. First conquered in 1951 by a New Zealand expedition.
- **River Drainage:** Flanked by the Tons (Yamuna tributary) and Kali river systems. Native flora: alpine rhododendrons.

3. AGRO POLICY: PM DHAN-DHANYA KRISHI YOJANA

- **Anniversary:** Marked its 1st anniversary (launched Oct 11, 2025 by Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan; active through 2030–31).
- **Objective:** Upgrade crop yields in 100 agricultural-deficit aspirational districts via 36 convergent sub-schemes across 28 States and 8 UTs.
- **Top-Performing Districts:** 1st: **Gaya (Bihar)**; 2nd: **Nagaur (Rajasthan)**; 3rd: **Umaria (Madhya Pradesh)**.

4. GUBERNATORIAL RESHUFFLE ACROSS SIX STATES

Pursuant to Articles 153, 155, and 156 of the Constitution, President Droupadi Murmu notified appointments/transfers of Governors:

State	Appointed Governor	Constitutional Highlights
Sikkim	Dushyant Gautam (replaces Om Prakash Mathur)	Art. 153 (Governor per State); Art. 155 (Appointed by Warrant under President's hand & seal)
Kerala	Om Prakash Mathur	Art. 156 (Holds office during pleasure of President; normal term 5 years)
Tamil Nadu	Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar	Art. 161 (Pardoning powers); Art. 213 (Promulgation of Ordinances during recess of Legislature)
Karnataka	Dr. Sudha Yadav	Art. 157 & 158 (Qualifications: Indian citizen, minimum 35 years of age, no office of profit)
Odisha	Brij Mohan Agrawal	Executive power of the State is vested in the Governor (Art. 154)
Uttarakhand	Dr. Dhal Singh Bisen	Constitutional head acting on Aid and Advice of CoM (Art. 163)

5. AWARDS, LITERACY & AVIATION INDUCTIONS

- **Légion d'Honneur for Sunil Bharti Mittal:** Bharti Enterprises Chairman conferred France's highest civilian honor (Knight of the Legion of Honour / *Chevalier*) by Emmanuel Macron. Preceded by KBE (UK, 2024) and Padma Bhushan (2007).
- **Dream Olympic 2036 Initiative:** Launched by Tamil Nadu to identify and train youth aged 8–18 in Chennai's newly built Olympic City, offering grants up to ₹50 lakh.
- **100% Literacy in Lakshadweep:** Became India's first UT to achieve 100% functional literacy under the **ULLAS (Nav Bharat Saksharta Karyakram)** scheme after 1,113 non-literate adults cleared the FLNAT exam.
- **ALH Dhruv MK-III Induction:** ICG inducted advanced twin-engine Light Combat Helicopters at Ratnagiri, Maharashtra, built by HAL Bengaluru. Features: 590 km range, 360-degree search radar, and night-vision EO pods.
- **ICC Players of the Month (Sept 2026):** Men's: **Shubman Gill** (record 5th career win); Women's: **Shafali Verma**.
- **Sports Literature:** *"Rag-Rag Mein Cricket"*, chronicling former MPCA player and BCCI selector Sanjay Jagdale, released by Sunil Gavaskar.

TAJ MAHAL (AGRA, UTTAR PRADESH)

UNESCO World Heritage Monument (1983) • New 7 Wonders of the World (2007)

1. IMPERIAL GENESIS & CONSTRUCTION CHRONOLOGY

Commissioned in 1631–1632 by the fifth Mughal Emperor **Shah Jahan** to enshrine the mortal remains of his consort Arjumand Banu Begum (**Mumtaz Mahal**), who passed away during childbirth in Burhanpur (1631). Erected along the southern bank of the Yamuna River in Agra over a 21-year period (completed 1653) at an estimated historical cost of 32 million rupees, employing over 20,000 artisans under royal supervision.

2. MASTER ARTISANS & ARCHITECTURAL SYNTHESIS

- **Chief Architect:** Master architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori** led the imperial board alongside Mir Abd-ul Karim. Calligraphy designed by Amanat Khan Shirazi.
- **Indo-Islamic Synthesis:** Blends Persian Timurid charbagh concepts with indigenous Indian stonecraft. Built with translucent white **Makrana marble** from Rajasthan, inlaid with 28 varieties of semi-precious stones (lapis lazuli, jade, carnelian).
- **Pietra Dura Inlay:** Highly intricate decorative hardstone inlay technique termed *Parchin Kari* adorning the cenotaph screens and spandrels.

3. STRUCTURAL & GEOMETRIC PERFECTION

- **Central Onion Dome:** Rises 73 meters (240 ft) on a high cylindrical drum, flanked by four smaller chhatris.
- **Minaret Engineering:** Four 40-meter-tall three-story minarets positioned at plinth corners tilt slightly outward to safeguard the tomb during seismic tremors.
- **Charbagh Matrix:** Four-quartered quadripartite paradise garden divided by intersecting water canals reflecting the mausoleum.

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (14 OCT)

- **PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan:** Completed 5 years on Oct 13, 2026; unifies multimodal logistics across 7 infrastructure engines (Roads, Railways, Airports, Ports, Waterways, Mass Transport, Logistics).
- **Submarine Cable Systems:** *I2C (India-to-Asia Subsea Cable)* connects landing stations across India, Malaysia, and Singapore.
- **Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026:** Conferred upon National Security Advisor **Ajit Doval** for distinguished strategic service.
- **Environmental Performance Index (EPI):** Yale University / Columbia University index assessing 180 countries across carbon mitigation, ecosystem vitality, and health.

1. REGIONAL GEOPOLITICS: FIRST BIMSTEC HOME MINISTERS MEETING

Union Home Minister Amit Shah presided over the inaugural **BIMSTEC Home Ministers Conference** in New Delhi on Oct 14–15, culminating in the adoption of the historic **New Delhi Declaration**.

- **Security Roadmap:** Institutionalized a zero-tolerance framework against transnational cyber crimes, illicit narcotics trafficking, maritime piracy, and violent extremism across the Bay of Bengal littoral. Joint drills: *PANEX* and *MILEX*.
- **Institutional Matrix:** BIMSTEC (est. June 6, 1997 via Bangkok Declaration; Secretariat in Dhaka) comprises **7 member states**: 5 South Asian (India, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka) and 2 Southeast Asian (Myanmar, Thailand).

2. IMF WORLD ECONOMIC OUTLOOK (WEO) PROJECTIONS

- **Growth Projections:** Upgraded India's FY27 GDP expansion forecast to **7.0%** (from 6.4%), projecting 7.2% for FY28.
- **Drivers:** Sustained capital expenditure, national infrastructure pipeline, supply chain relocations, and digital public goods.
- **Institutional Structure:** IMF established 1944 (Bretton Woods); 190 member nations; MD: Kristalina Georgieva; First DMD: Nigel Chalk / Gita Gopinath. Special Drawing Rights (SDR) basket: USD, EUR, CNY, JPY, GBP.

3. WILDLIFE PHOTOGRAPHER OF THE YEAR (60TH EDITION)

- **Global Winner:** 14-year-old Zimbabwean wildlife photographer **Oscar Field** clinched the *Young Wildlife Photographer of the Year*.
- **Winning Visual:** Titled *"Labour of Love"*, capturing a dung beetle rolling a brood ball with immense mechanical effort. Presented by the Natural History Museum, London.
- **Green Oscar Context:** Whitley Gold Award 2026 awarded to Indian marine biologist **Purnima Devi Barman / Parveen Sheikh**.

4. SPORTS & TELECOMMUNICATION INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Men's Asian Champions Trophy Hockey:** Awarded to **Punjab** (to be staged at Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium, Jalandhar & Mohali, Oct 27–Nov 5). India has claimed this title a record 5 times.
- **World Bowls Championship:** Assam's **Putul Sonowal** made sports history by clinching India's maiden international bronze medal in Berri, South Australia.
- **10th India Mobile Congress (IMC 2026):** Inaugurated by PM Modi and Union Telecom Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia at Yashobhoomi (IICC), Dwarka, New Delhi. Central theme: *"Scale Without Boundaries: Advancing 5G/6G, Semi-Conductors & Sovereign AI"*.

5. HEALTH, RURAL MARKETS & CULTURAL OBITS

- **First High-Altitude Health Research Centre:** Operationalized at Keylong (Lahaul & Spiti, Himachal Pradesh) by ICMR and inaugurated by local MP Kangana Ranaut alongside Health Minister J.P. Nadda.
- **National Saras Mela 2026:** Inaugurated by President Droupadi Murmu at Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, showcasing over 1,500 rural SHG artisans with a dedicated *Lakhpati Didi Pavilion* (scheme launched Aug 15, 2023).
- **Nameri Wild Classrooms:** Implemented at Nameri Tiger Reserve (Assam) along the Jia Bharali River for experiential student ecology learning and whitewater navigation.
- **Obituary (Mridangam Legend):** Renowned Carnatic percussionist and Padma Shri recipient **Guruvayur Dorai** passed away in Chennai at age 91. Expert in the jackfruit-wood *Mridangam* tradition.

GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT HAMPI (BELLARY / VIJAYANAGARA, KARNATAKA)

UNESCO World Heritage Site (1986) • Featured on ₹50 Currency Note

1. THE VIJAYANAGARA IMPERIAL CAPITAL ON THE TUNGABHADRA

Hampi (ancient *Pampa Kshetra*), situated along the south bank of the sacred Tungabhadra River, served as the imperial capital of the **Vijayanagara Empire**, founded in 1336 CE by brothers **Harihara I and Bukka Raya I** of the Sangama dynasty. It reached its political, cultural, and architectural apogee under **Emperor Krishnadevaraya** (Tuluva dynasty, 1509–1529 CE) before being plundered following the catastrophic Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi, 1565 CE).

2. SIGNATURE TEMPLES & STONE CHARIOT

- **Vijaya Vittala Temple:** Represents the zenith of Vijayanagara Dravidian architecture. Encloses the world-famous **Stone Chariot (Garuda Shrine)** and the Ranga Mandapa with 56 carved *musical pillars* (SaReGaMa pillars) that emit acoustic resonances.
- **Virupaksha Temple:** Dedicated to Lord Shiva (Virupaksha/Pampa) with a 50-meter-high eastern Gopuram, active since the 7th century CE.
- **Hazara Rama Temple:** Known for exterior bas-relief friezes illustrating the entire narrative of the Ramayana.

3. SECULAR & CIVIL STRUCTURES

- **Lotus Mahal & Elephant Stables:** Indo-Islamic secular pavilions characterized by ribbed lotus plaster vaulted domes and multi-foliated Islamic arches.
- **Queen's Bath:** Royal subterranean stepped reservoir equipped with aqueduct networks and arched balconies.
- **Mahanavami Dibba:** Massive 3-tiered granite ceremonial platform from which Vijayanagara monarchs reviewed Navratri army parades.

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (15 OCT)

- **National Sports Day (Aug 29):** Commemorates the birth anniversary of hockey wizard Major Dhyan Chand. India's highest sports award: Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna.
- **Men's Hockey World Cup History:** India lifted its maiden Men's FIH Hockey World Cup trophy in 1975 at Kuala Lumpur (defeating Pakistan 2–1 under captain Ajit Pal Singh).
- **Rathwa Tribe & Pithora Art:** Ritualistic wall murals painted in Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh honoring indigenous deities (Pithora Dev), using natural mineral pigments.
- **Wetlands in the News:** Glo Lake (101st Ramsar site, Arunachal Pradesh); Om Lake (Umiam Lake, Meghalaya).

1. BANKING DISINVESTMENT: STRATEGIC SALE OF IDBI BANK

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the strategic disinvestment of a **60.72% combined equity stake** in IDBI Bank for **₹52,878 crore** to Toronto-based **Fairfax Financial Holdings** (led by Indian-Canadian financier Prem Watsa).

- **Stake Composition:** Government of India offloaded 30.48% (retaining ~15%), while Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) divested 30.24% (retaining ~19%).
- **Historical Background:** Established in 1964 as the Industrial Development Bank of India under an Act of Parliament; categorized as a private sector bank post-2019 following LIC's 51% controlling acquisition.

2. HYDROCARBON GEOPOLITICS: OMAN AS #1 LNG SUPPLIER

- **Rank Shift:** The Sultanate of **Oman** surpassed the United States to become India's primary Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) supplier in Sept 2026, delivering 585,000 metric tons.
- **Supplier Ranking:** 1st: Oman; 2nd: Nigeria; 3rd: United States.
- **Geostrategic Context:** Capital: Muscat; controls the southern side of the *Strait of Hormuz* alongside Iran. Maritime chokepoints handle ~20% of global petroleum petroleum transit.

3. MILITARY ACCOLADE: CAMBRIAN PATROL GOLD FOR ASSAM REGT

- **Military Feat:** The **Assam Regiment (Bhairab Battalion)** secured the Gold Medal at **Ex Cambrian Patrol 2026** in Brecon, Wales, UK.
- **The 'Olympics of Military Patrolling':** Instituted in 1959, the grueling 48-hour tactical patrol covers 60 km across the rugged Cambrian Mountains with 30 kg combat kit, testing navigation and counter-drone warfare.

4. GLOBAL URBAN LIVING: FRIENDLIEST CITIES INDEX 2026

The global index compiled by *Far & Real* evaluated 200 cities on digital discourse friendliness, civic openness, and tourist hospitality:

- **Top 3 Friendliest:** 1st: **Mérida (Mexico)**; 2nd: **Glasgow (Scotland, UK)**; 3rd: **Bogotá (Colombia)**.
- **Bottom Ranked:** Buenos Aires (Argentina) placed 200th. New Delhi placed 193rd (Score: 43.6).
- **Diplomatic Footprint:** India operationalized its full Resident Diplomatic Mission in **San José, Costa Rica**, strengthening access to the Central American corridor bordered by the Pacific Ocean and Caribbean Sea.

5. MILITARY LOGISTICS, OBSERVANCES & NAVAL COMMISSIONING

- **'Bharat Rice' for Armed Forces:** Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Consumer Affairs Minister Pralhad Joshi launched dedicated high-altitude packaged *Bharat Rice* (10 kg and 30 kg packs) produced via FCI for forward troops in Siachen, Ladakh, and Arunachal.
- **World Standards Day (Oct 14):** Celebrated under the theme: *"Shared Vision for a Better World: Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure"*.
- **World Students Day (Oct 15):** Commemorates the birth anniversary of 11th President **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam** (1931–2015; Bharat Ratna 1997; author of *Wings of Fire* and *Ignited Minds*).
- **Multi-Purpose Vessel 'Samarthak':** The Indian Navy commissioned its first indigenous 106-meter MPV built by L&T Shipyard at Kattupalli, inducted at Karwar Naval Base for towing, salvage, and HADR.
- **Bloomberg New Economy Forum:** Convened its inaugural Indian summit in New Delhi (theme: *"A World in Play"*).
- **Commonwealth Cue Sports:** Concluded in Ahmedabad; England led the gold tally, while India took 2nd place overall with **13 medals** (3 Gold, 5 Silver, 5 Bronze).

RAMAPPA TEMPLE / RUDRESHWARA (MULUGU, TELANGANA)

UNESCO World Heritage Site (Inscribed 2021, 39th Site) • Kakatiya Engineering Wonder

1. THE TEMPLE NAMED AFTER ITS ARCHITECT

The Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple at Palampet village, Mulugu District, Telangana, is India's only temple named after its master sculptor, **Ramappa**. Commissioned in 1213 CE by **Recharla Rudra**, a commanding general under Kakatiya King **Ganapati Deva**. The walled complex took over 40 years to complete. Marco Polo famously celebrated it as the *"brightest star in the galaxy of medieval temples"*.

2. MEDIEVAL ENGINEERING & FLOATING BRICKS

- **Floating Brick Superstructure:** The temple Vimana (tower) is constructed using uniquely porous "floating bricks" (spongy clay mixed with sawdust and acacia gum) with densities lower than water, reducing structural load on pillars.
- **Sandbox Foundation:** Built atop a trench filled with sand, crushed granite, and jaggery paste, absorbing earthquake vibrations during seismic events.
- **Stellate Platform:** The entire sandstone temple sits atop a 6-foot-high star-shaped raised platform (Upapitha).

3. SCULPTURAL AESTHETICS & BRACKET FIGURES

- **Madanikas / Salabhanjikas:** Twelve dynamic, elongated black basalt bracket figures depicting celestial damsels and dancers showcasing Kakatiya natya postures.
- **Monolithic Nandi:** An imposing, monolithic black basalt Nandi bull sits in a separate pavilion, appearing alert from any viewing angle.
- **Sanctum:** Enshrines the Shiva lingam (Ramalingeswara Swamy) rising 9 feet within the inner sanctum.

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (16 OCT)

- **FADA Leadership:** Sai Giridhar elected as 38th President of the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations.
- **Pioneering Aviation Milestones:** Air Vice Marshal / Surgeon Commodore Arti Sarin appointed Director General Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS).
- **Bilateral Drills:** *Ex Veer Guardian* (Indian Air Force and Japan Air Self-Defense Force at Hyakuri / Komatsu).
- **Global Wetland Ledger:** India’s Ramsar network expanded to 103 designated sites with the dual inclusion of Sukhna Lake (Chandigarh) and Sau Jheel (UP).

1. CONSERVATION LEDGER: INDIA'S 102ND & 103RD RAMSAR SITES

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change announced that two major aquatic biomes have been designated as Ramsar Sites of International Importance, taking India's tally to **103**.

- **102nd Site — Sukhna Lake (Chandigarh):** Created in 1958 by architect Le Corbusier and Chief Engineer P.L. Verma by damming the seasonal Sukhna Choe stream descending from the Shivalik foothills. Serves as a vital wintering haven for migratory waterfowl (Brahminy duck, Pintails).
- **103rd Site — Sau Jheel (Mainpuri, Uttar Pradesh):** A perennial oxbow wetland system within the Indo-Gangetic floodplain adjacent to the Saman Bird Sanctuary. A key nesting ground for the Vulnerable Sarus Crane and the indigenous freshwater fish *Chitala chitala*.
- **National Context:** Tamil Nadu holds the maximum sites (20), followed by Uttar Pradesh (17). Largest: Sundarbans (WB); Smallest: Renuka Wetland (HP); Oldest: Chilika Lake (Odisha) & Keoladeo National Park (Rajasthan, 1981).

2. HENLEY PASSPORT INDEX (Q4 2026)

- **India's Ranking:** Ranked **84th** (visa-free or visa-on-arrival access to 58 destinations), sharing the spot with Algeria and Mauritania (85th in 2025; 81st in July 2026).
- **Top Spots:** 1st: **Singapore** (visa-free access to 195 destinations); 2nd: Japan; 3rd: South Korea.
- **Bottom:** Afghanistan ranked lowest at 104th (28 destinations).

3. GLOBAL HUNGER INDEX (GHI 2026)

- **Publisher:** Concern Worldwide & Welthungerhilfe.
- **India's Score:** Ranked **100th out of 122 nations** (Score: 27.3, categorized as "Serious"). Up slightly from 102nd in 2025.
- **Assessment Dimensions:** Undernourishment, Child Stunting, Child Wasting, and Under-5 Child Mortality. Highest child wasting rate globally (~18.7%).

4. WELFARE GOVERNANCE, AI & AGRICULTURE POLICIES

- **NSAP Rebranded as PMSSY:** The National Social Assistance Programme renamed **Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana** (budget: ₹53,428 crore for FY27–FY31 across 36 States/UTs). Monthly pensions: ₹375/month for disabled citizens aged up to 79; ₹625/month for senior citizens aged 80+.
- **India's AI Cultural Avatar 'DEVI':** Indian Embassy in Jakarta, Indonesia unveiled *DEVI (Digital Emissary for Virtual Interaction)* on Navratri, capable of conversing in English and Bahasa Indonesia.
- **High-Altitude Solar Storage in Spiti:** HP inaugurated a 2 MW battery energy storage solar facility in Kaza (Spiti Valley), generating 36 lakh units annually along the Spiti River.
- **Sugar Cane Advisory Committee:** NITI Aayog panel chaired by **Prof. Ramesh Chand** established to recommend Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) methodologies under the Essential Commodities Act.

5. LITERARY RELEASES, SPORTS & GLOBAL HEALTH

- **World Food Day (Oct 16):** Celebrates the 1945 founding of the FAO (Rome). 2026 Theme: *"Innovate Today, Nourish Tomorrow: Right to Foods for a Better Life"*.
- **Presidential Memoir in Hindi:** Former President Ram Nath Kovind's autobiography *"Triumph of the Indian Republic"* released in Hindi as *"Nij Jeevan Ki Chhata"* in Lucknow by CM Yogi Adityanath.
- **U-23 World Wrestling Championship:** Indian grappler **Vishwajeet Ramchandra** clinched a historic Silver medal in the 55 kg Greco-Roman category in Las Vegas, USA.

RAMANATHASWAMY TEMPLE (RAMESHWARAM, TAMIL NADU)

Char Dham & Jyotirlinga Pilgrimage Sanctum • The World's Longest Temple Corridor

1. THE SACRED ISLAND & RAMAYANA TRADITIONS

Ramanathaswamy Temple is located on the conch-shaped Pamban Island in the Gulf of Mannar, Ramanathapuram District, Tamil Nadu. Connected to mainland India via the historic 1914 Pamban Rail Bridge and the new vertical-lift bridge. Scriptural traditions record that Lord Rama worshipped Lord Shiva here to expiate the sin of killing Ravana (Brahmahatya dosha). Sita fashioned the main lingam (*Ramalingam*) from sea sand, while Hanuman brought the *Viswalingam* from Mount Kailash.

2. DRAVIDIAN GRANDEUR & THE GREAT CORRIDORS

- **The Outer Third Corridor:** The world's longest pillared temple corridor, running 1,220 meters (approx. 4,000 ft) long with 1,212 elaborately carved granite pillars. Constructed in the 18th century by Muthuramalinga Sethupathi.
- **Dynastic Contributions:** Expanded from a modest thatched shrine by the early Pandya dynasty (12th century), Jaffna kings, and Nayak rulers of Madurai.
- **Towering Gopurams:** Marked by a towering 10-story Eastern Gopuram rising 38 meters (126 ft) and an 8-story Western Gopuram.

3. TEERTHAMS, DHANUSHKODI & CHAR DHAM

- **22 Sacred Theerthams:** Pilgrims bathe in 22 natural freshwater temple wells before entering the sanctum; the outermost is *Agni Theertham* on the sea coast.
- **Char Dham Alignment:** Northern Dham: Badrinath (Uttarakhand); Eastern: Puri (Odisha); Western: Dwarka (Gujarat); Southern: Rameshwaram (Tamil Nadu). Also one of the 12 Jyotirlingas.
- **Dhanushkodi:** Located at the southeastern tip of Pamban Island where the Bay of Bengal meets the Indian Ocean (destroyed in the 1964 cyclone; starting point of Rama Setu).

4. EXAMINATION QUICK REVISION & ONE-LINERS (17 OCT)

- **Universal Postal Union (UPU):** Founded Oct 9, 1874 (Treaty of Bern, Switzerland). Observed annually as World Post Day.
- **Food & Agriculture Organization (FAO):** Specialized UN agency created on Oct 16, 1945 in Quebec, Canada (HQ in Rome, Italy). Director-General: Qu Dongyu.
- **Constitutional Status of Social Schemes:** Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV): Article 41 directs public assistance in cases of old age, sickness, and disablement.
- **Tirupati Laddoo GI Certification:** Conferred GI certification in 2009 for the sacred Tirumala Venkateswara temple prasadam under the GI Act 1999.

1. THEMATIC CONSOLIDATION: GLOBAL INDICES, SUMMITS & AWARDS

Index / Conference	Issuing Agency	India Rank / Top Nations	Core Parameters / Notes
Global Innovation Index 2026	WIPO (Geneva)	India: **38th** / 1st: Switzerland, 2nd: Sweden	Evaluated 139 economies across institutions, human capital, market sophistication
Henley Passport Index Q4 2026	IATA / Henley & Partners	India: **84th** (58 destinations) / 1st: Singapore	World's most powerful travel passports; Afghanistan placed 104th (lowest)
Global Hunger Index 2026	Welthungerhilfe & Concern Worldwide	India: **100th** (Score 27.3) / Lowest: Somalia, Yemen	Focus on child wasting (18.7%), child stunting, undernourishment, child mortality
Friendliest Cities Index 2026	Far & Real Urban Studies	1st: Mérida (Mexico), 2nd: Glasgow / Delhi: 193rd	Evaluated 200 cities on civic harmony, openness, and online dialogue quality
BIMSTEC Home Ministers Summit	BIMSTEC Secretariat	New Delhi (Chaired by Amit Shah)	Adopted New Delhi Declaration; institutionalized zero-tolerance against terror
Nobel Prize in Economics 2026	Sveriges Riksbank / Royal Swedish Academy	Robert Hall & Michael Woodford (USA)	Formulated macroeconomic stabilization and dynamic monetary policies

2. DEFENSE, BILATERAL DRILLS & NAVIES

- **Ex INDRA 2026:** India-Russia naval maneuvers at Vladivostok; INS Sahyadri participated.
- **Ex IBSAMAR IX:** India-Brazil-South Africa drills off Simon's Town; INS Tarkash deployed.
- **Ex Konkan 2026:** Royal Navy-Indian Navy drills at Plymouth, UK; INS Trishul deployed.
- **Ex Cambrian Patrol:** Assam Regiment's Bhairab Battalion secured Gold in Wales, UK.
- **New Inductions:** ICGS *Ajit* (Goa Shipyard), ASW-SWC *Mangrol* (CSL), NG-OPV *Shreyas* (GRSE), MPV *Samarthak* (L&T).

3. NATIONAL GOVERNANCE & APPOINTMENTS

- **New Governors:** Dushyant Gautam (Sikkim), O.P. Mathur (Kerala), R.V. Arlekar (TN), Dr. Sudha Yadav (Karnataka), B.M. Agrawal (Odisha), Dr. D.S. Bisen (Uttarakhand).
- **Election Commission:** Prakash Rajpurohit appointed Deputy Election Commissioner.
- **Judicial Health:** Justice K.V. Viswanathan to lead the Judicial Well-Being Committee.
- **Ramsar Network:** Expanded to 103 with Sukhna Lake (102nd, Chandigarh) & Sau Jheel (103rd, UP).

4. ENVIRONMENT, ENERGY & TECHNOLOGY DIGEST

- **Hydro Supply Reversal:** Oman overtook the United States as India's #1 supplier of Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) in September 2026.
- **Clean Energy in Himalayas:** 2 MW solar battery storage system operationalized at Kaza, Spiti Valley, Himachal Pradesh.
- **Agricultural Scheme Rebrand:** NSAP renamed *Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana (PMSSY)* with ₹53,428 cr outlays.
- **Telecom Hardware Push:** 10th India Mobile Congress (Yashobhoomi, New Delhi) launched foundational architectures for 6G and indigenous semiconductor manufacturing.

5. SPORTS REGISTERS & LITERARY RELEASES

- **World Bowls Bronze:** Putul Sonowal (Assam) secured India's historic first international medal in Berri, Australia.
- **World Wrestling U-23:** Vishwajeet Ramchandra bagged Silver (55 kg Greco-Roman) in Las Vegas, USA.
- **Hockey Tournament Venue:** Surjit Singh Stadium (Jalandhar, Punjab) selected for Men's Asian Champions Trophy.
- **Literary Releases:** *"Nij Jeevan Ki Chhata"* (Hindi translation of former President Ram Nath Kovind's memoirs) launched by CM Yogi Adityanath. *"Rag-Rag Mein Cricket"* (chronicling Sanjay Jagdale) released by Sunil Gavaskar.

1. KOLKATA DURGA PUJA STAMPEDE: CHORBAGAN TRAGEDY

A major crowd surge occurred during evening Navratri festivities at the Chorbagan Durga Puja pandal in North Kolkata, West Bengal, claiming ~20 lives with over 25 injured, triggered by sudden downpours and overcrowding.

- **Administrative Response:** The West Bengal government announced ex-gratia compensation of ₹25 lakh per deceased along with state employment support. Organizers were detained for safety violations.
- **UNESCO Cultural Heritage Context:** *Durga Puja in Kolkata* was inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2021 (India's 14th inscription). Diwali was subsequently inscribed as the 16th element. Tangible Heritage: Sarnath inscribed as India's 45th site.

2. DIPLOMATIC ENVOY TO NEPAL: SUDHAKAR DALELA

- **Diplomatic Assignment:** Senior IFS diplomat (1993 batch) **Sudhakar Dalela** named India's next Ambassador to Nepal.
- **Distinguished Career:** Served as India's Ambassador to Bhutan, Chief Sherpa for the 18th BRICS Summit (2026), and coordinated the I2U2 minilateral group (India, Israel, UAE, USA).
- **Border Dynamics:** India-Nepal ties involve the Mahakali Treaty, Kalapani-Lipulekh territorial discussions, and joint military exercise *Surya Kiran*.

3. GLOBAL FINANCIAL ASSEMBLIES: PAKISTAN 2027

- **Host Designation:** The Board of Governors of the **World Bank and IMF** confirmed Pakistan will host their Annual Meetings in 2027 in Islamabad (74 years after Karachi hosted in 1953).
- **Comparative Summits:** 2026 World Bank-IMF meet held in Bangkok, Thailand. SCO Heads of Government 2026 held in Kyrgyzstan, with the 2027 summit slated for Pakistan. BRICS 2027 will be hosted by China.

4. MULTILATERAL SECURITY: 7TH CICA MINISTERIAL IN BAKU

- **Summit Venue:** 7th Ministerial Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia (CICA) convened in Baku, Azerbaijan, on the Caspian Sea coast.
- **Origins & Expansion:** Proposed in 1992 by Kazakhstan's President Nursultan Nazarbayev. Comprises 28 member states (India is a founding member; Laos is the newest entrant). Minister of State Kirti Vardhan Singh represented India.

5. CLEAN ENERGY, FISCAL GOVERNANCE & INDIGENOUS DEFENSE

- **Bharat Stage VII (BS-VII) Automotive Roadmap:** Ministry of Road Transport announced Phase I of BS-VII emission standards will take effect on **April 1, 2029**, followed by Phase II on **April 1, 2031**, to curb particulate emissions and advance India's Net Zero 2070 climate goals.
- **World Health Summit 2026:** Convened in Berlin, Germany by WHO under the theme: *"From Crisis to Resilience: Digital Health, Sovereign AI, and Equitable Access"*.
- **GST Council Standing Committee:** Institutionalized a 12-member committee with **5 permanent state representatives** (Karnataka, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh) and 7 rotational seats to streamline indirect tax consensus.
- **Indigenous Micro-Missile 'Jwala':** Private defense firm IG Drones / IG Defence unveiled the *Jwala* surface-to-air micro-missile (2–5 km range; 5,000 m altitude ceiling) with AI optical targeting to neutralize swarming drones.
- **Obituary (Agro-Conservationist):** Padma Shri recipient **Cheruvayal Raman**, known as the "Guardian of Paddy" for preserving over 45 indigenous heirloom rice varieties in Wayanad, Kerala, passed away at age 74.
- **Asian Para Games 2026 Flag Bearers:** The opening ceremony in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan saw sprinter **Simran Sharma** and shuttler **Pramod Bhagat** lead the Indian contingent (Bhavina Patel was rested ahead of her table tennis matches).

ALL-INCLUSIVE DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS & STATIC GK MCQ BANK

Rigorous multiple-choice questions with answers and detailed conceptual rationales

1. The devastating October 2026 flash floods in Nepal's Gorkha District were caused by the overflow of which transboundary river?

A) Kali River B) Budhi Gandaki River C) Trishuli River D) Arun River

Answer: B) Budhi Gandaki River | Explanation: Originates on the slopes of Mount Manaslu, passes through Gorkha, joins the Trishuli, and forms the Narayani (Gandak) River flowing into Bihar, India.

2. According to UNCTAD's Trade and Development Report, what was India's growth in greenfield project investments?

A) 3.5% B) 5.7% C) 7.0% D) 12.2%

Answer: C) 7.0% | Explanation: India recorded a 7.0% surge in greenfield capital investments, accounting for 5.7% of total national projects (compared to 2.8% in China).

3. The floral festival 'Bathukamma', celebrated primarily across Telangana during Navratri, historically traces its origins to which dynastic rule?

A) Chola and Kakatiya Dynasties B) Hoysala Dynasty C) Pallava Dynasty D) Rashtrakuta Dynasty

Answer: A) Chola and Kakatiya Dynasties | Explanation: Bathukamma is celebrated by women arranging seasonal flowers in concentric layers over nine days, tracing roots to the Western Chalukyas, Cholas, and Kakatiyas.

4. The fast patrol vessel ICGS 'Ajit', commissioned into the Indian Coast Guard at Okha, was constructed under which indigenous vessel class?

A) Samar Class B) Aadesh Class C) Adamya Class D) Rajshree Class

Answer: C) Adamya Class | Explanation: ICGS Ajit was built by Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) as part of an eight-vessel Adamya-class coastal surveillance patrol order.

5. Under West Bengal's 'Bhagini Nivedita Scheme', what total financial grant is provided to unmarried women for higher education?

A) ₹25,000 B) ₹50,000 C) ₹75,000 D) ₹1,00,000

Answer: B) ₹50,000 | Explanation: The state government delivers ₹50,000 across three installments (₹17,000, ₹17,000, and ₹16,000) for higher collegiate education.

6. Project Seabird Phase IIA, inaugurated by the Chief of Defence Staff, represents the ongoing modernization of which Indian naval base?

A) INS Dega, Visakhapatnam B) Karwar Naval Base (INS Kadamba), Karnataka C) INS Mandovi, Goa D) INS Vajrabahu, Mumbai

Answer: B) Karwar Naval Base (INS Kadamba), Karnataka | Explanation: Established in 1986 under Project Seabird to create India's largest deep-water naval base on the western seaboard.

7. Adani Power's joint venture with Druk Green Power Corporation (DGPC) to develop a 770 MW hydro plant in Bhutan is situated on which river?

A) Wangchhu River B) Punatsangchhu River C) Chamkharchhu River D) Mangdechhu River

Answer: C) Chamkharchhu River | Explanation: The Chamkharchhu-I Hydroelectric Project operates on a BOOT model with 49% equity held by Adani and 51% by DGPC Bhutan.

8. Which Indian Institute of Technology developed the mobile application 'AVNI' to promote agricultural literacy among school children?

A) IIT Madras B) IIT Ropar C) IIT Kharagpur D) IIT Roorkee

Answer: B) IIT Ropar | Explanation: IIT Ropar developed the AVNI platform to integrate agronomy and soil science education into foundational school learning.

9. The traditional temple prasadam 'Mohanthal', recently granted the Geographical Indication (GI) tag, belongs to which historic shrine?

A) Somnath Temple B) Ambaji Temple, Gujarat C) Dwarkadhish Temple D) Mahakaleshwar Temple

Answer: B) Ambaji Temple, Gujarat | Explanation: Mohanthal is a traditional sweet made from roasted besan, mawa, sugar, and ghee, presented at the Arasur Ambaji Shaktipeeth.

10. The bilateral maritime exercise 'INDRA 2026' was conducted between the Indian Navy and Russian Navy

11. Who were awarded the 2026 Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel?

A) Daron Acemoglu & Simon Johnson B) Robert Hall & Michael Woodford C) Claudia Goldin & Paul Krugman D) Ben Bernanke & Douglas Diamond

Answer: B) Robert Hall & Michael Woodford | Explanation: Honored for empirical studies establishing the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic policy stabilization and inflation targets.

12. The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple at Ayodhya received which official food safety quality certification from FSSAI?

A) Clean Street Food Hub B) Eat Right Place of Worship C) BHOG Certification D) Green Kitchen Seal

Answer: B) Eat Right Place of Worship | Explanation: FSSAI awarded the temple this certification through Oct 2028 after rigorous audits of hygiene, prasadam purity, and water safety.

13. Who was appointed as the Deputy Election Commissioner of India in October 2026 for a tenure extending through April 2030?

A) Vivek Joshi B) Prakash Rajpurohit C) Sanjay Malhotra D) Gyanesh Kumar

Answer: B) Prakash Rajpurohit | Explanation: Appointed by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) to replace Sanjay Kumar at Nirvachan Sadan.

14. The Supreme Court established a five-member Standing Committee on Judicial Well-Being under the chairmanship of which sitting judge?

A) Justice Surya Kant B) Justice B.V. Nagarathna C) Justice K.V. Viswanathan D) Justice P.S. Narasimha

Answer: C) Justice K.V. Viswanathan | Explanation: Formed by the CJI on World Mental Health Day to address judicial stress, mental health, and institutional work-life balance.

15. What rank did India secure globally in WIPO's Global Innovation Index (GII) 2026 among 139 evaluated economies?

A) 48th B) 40th C) 38th D) 31st

Answer: C) 38th | Explanation: India climbed to 38th position (up from 81st in 2015), leading the lower-middle-income and Central/South Asian regions. Switzerland ranked 1st.

16. The Indian Navy launched 'Shreyas', the third Next-Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NG-OPV), constructed by which defense shipyard?

A) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders B) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers C) Cochin Shipyard D) Goa Shipyard

Answer: B) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) | Explanation: GRSE Kolkata delivered Shreyas (top speed 23 knots), following sister vessels Sanghamitra and Shruti.

17. Which Indian cricket icon was appointed UNICEF India's Celebrity Advocate on the International Day of the Girl Child?

A) Harmanpreet Kaur B) Mithali Raj C) Smriti Mandhana D) Shafali Verma

Answer: C) Smriti Mandhana | Explanation: Appointed to champion gender equality, sports participation, and adolescent girls' educational rights under the #PromiseToChildren campaign.

18. The trilateral naval drill Exercise IBSAMAR IX was conducted off Simon's Town, South Africa, featuring which Indian warship?

A) INS Tabar B) INS Teg C) INS Tarkash D) INS Trikand

Answer: C) INS Tarkash | Explanation: INS Tarkash deployed for the joint India-Brazil-South Africa exercise in the southern Atlantic littoral.

19. An elite mountaineering expedition of the Indian Coast Guard successfully scaled which Himalayan peak (7,045 m) in October 2026?

A) Mount Trishul B) Mount Mukut C) Mount Kamet D) Mount Nanda Ghunti

Answer: B) Mount Mukut | Explanation: Scaled by the ICG mountaineering team under the "Tat Se Parvat" mission in the Garhwal Himalayas of Uttarakhand.

20. Which district was recognized as the best-performing district under the first-year review of PM Dhan-Dhanya Krishi Yojana?

A) Nagaur, Rajasthan B) Gaya, Bihar C) Umaria, Madhya Pradesh D) Varanasi, UP

Answer: B) Gaya, Bihar | Explanation: Gaya ranked 1st nationally for boosting yields and revitalizing fallow land across 100 agricultural-deficit districts.

21. Following the October 2026 gubernatorial notifications, who was sworn in as the Governor of Sikkim?

A) Om Prakash Mathur B) Rajendra Arlekar C) Dushyant Gautam D) Brij Mohan Agrawal

Answer: C) Dushyant Gautam | Explanation: Appointed Governor of Sikkim by President Droupadi Murmu, with Om Prakash Mathur reassigned to Kerala.

22. Telecom pioneer Sunil Bharti Mittal was conferred France's highest civilian honor, the 'Chevalier de la Légion d'Honneur', instituted by whom?

A) King Louis XIV B) Napoleon Bonaparte C) Charles de Gaulle D) Jacques Chirac

Answer: B) Napoleon Bonaparte | Explanation: Established in 1802 by First Consul Napoleon Bonaparte; Mittal was honored for advancing global telecommunication links.

23. Which Indian Union Territory achieved 100% functional literacy under the ULLAS (Nav Bharat Saksharta Karyakram) scheme?

A) Puducherry B) Andaman & Nicobar C) Lakshadweep D) Ladakh

Answer: C) Lakshadweep | Explanation: Administrator Praful Patel certified 100% literacy after 1,113 adult learners passed the foundational FLNAT evaluation.

24. What milestone did Indian batter Shubman Gill achieve regarding the ICC Men's Player of the Month award in October 2026?

A) First Indian to win 3 times B) Record 5-time recipient C) Youngest ever recipient D) First to win across three formats

Answer: B) Record 5-time recipient | Explanation: Shubman Gill claimed his 5th career ICC Player of the Month award (September 2026), matching West Indies star Hayley Matthews.

25. The inaugural BIMSTEC Home Ministers Meeting in New Delhi concluded with the adoption of which framework declaration?

A) Bangkok Security Charter B) Dhaka Protocol C) New Delhi Declaration D) Bay of Bengal Accord

Answer: C) New Delhi Declaration | Explanation: Chaired by Amit Shah, the declaration established joint counter-terror, anti-narcotics, and maritime safety protocols.

26. In its October 2026 World Economic Outlook update, what did the IMF project for India's GDP growth in FY 2026–27?

A) 6.4% B) 6.8% C) 7.0% D) 7.5%

Answer: C) 7.0% | Explanation: Upgraded from 6.4% to 7.0% (and 7.2% for FY28), citing capital investment, public infrastructure, and resilient domestic demand.

27. Oscar Field clinched the Young Wildlife Photographer of the Year award for 'Labour of Love', featuring which insect?

A) Weaver Ant B) Dung Beetle C) Monarch Butterfly D) Cicada

Answer: B) Dung Beetle | Explanation: The 14-year-old Zimbabwean captured a dung beetle maneuvering an oversized brood ball with its hind legs.

28. Which Indian state was selected to host the Men's Asian Champions Trophy Hockey tournament in late October 2026?

A) Odisha B) Tamil Nadu C) Punjab D) Haryana

Answer: C) Punjab | Explanation: Hosted at the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium in Jalandhar and Mohali (India previously won the tournament 5 times).

29. Who became the first Indian athlete to win an international medal at the World Bowls Championship in Australia?

A) Nayanmoni Saikia B) Lovely Choubey C) Putul Sonowal D) Pinki Singh

Answer: C) Putul Sonowal | Explanation: Assam's Putul Sonowal secured an individual Bronze medal in lawn bowls, defeating his Singaporean competitor in Berri, Australia.

30. What was the designated central theme for the 10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC 2026) in New Delhi?

A) Future Tech for Bharat B) Scale Without Boundaries C) Connecting the Next Billion D) Sovereign AI Now

Answer: B) Scale Without Boundaries | Explanation: Focused on 5G expansion, 6G research, indigenous semiconductor manufacturing, and secure digital telecommunications.

31. India's first High-Altitude Health Research Centre was established by ICMR at which location in Himachal Pradesh?

A) Dharamshala B) Keylong (Lahaul & Spiti) C) Reckong Peo D) Manali

Answer: B) Keylong (Lahaul & Spiti) | Explanation: Set up by ICMR to pioneer research into hypoxia, mountain sickness, and high-altitude emergency trauma response.

32. Legendary Carnatic percussionist and Padma Shri recipient Guruvayur Dorai, who passed away in October 2026, played which instrument?

A) Ghatam B) Mridangam C) Kanjira D) Tavil

Answer: B) Mridangam | Explanation: A maestro of the Mridangam for over seven decades, crafting rhythms on jackfruit-wood double-sided percussion barrels.

33. Which global asset management corporation acquired a 60.72% controlling stake in IDBI Bank for ₹52,878 crore?

A) BlackRock B) Fairfax Financial Holdings C) SoftBank Group D) Temasek Holdings

Answer: B) Fairfax Financial Holdings | Explanation: Led by Prem Watsa; acquired combined shares divested by the Government of India and LIC.

34. Which nation surpassed the United States in September 2026 to emerge as India's largest Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) supplier?

A) Qatar B) Sultanate of Oman C) UAE D) Australia

Answer: B) Sultanate of Oman | Explanation: Oman supplied 585,000 metric tons of LNG, moving past the US and Nigeria in monthly bilateral volume shipments.

35. The Indian Army's Assam Regiment (Bhairab Battalion) won the prestigious Gold Medal at Ex Cambrian Patrol 2026 held in:

A) Salisbury Plain, England B) Brecon, Wales, UK C) Highlands, Scotland D) Galway, Ireland

Answer: B) Brecon, Wales, UK | Explanation: The grueling 48-hour tactical patrol competition across the Cambrian Mountains featured over 100 international military units.

36. Which global city was ranked #1 in the Friendliest Cities Index 2026 compiled by international urban research group 'Far & Real'?

A) Glasgow, Scotland B) Mérida, Mexico C) Kyoto, Japan D) Dublin, Ireland

Answer: B) Mérida, Mexico | Explanation: Mérida took 1st place for civic warmth and positive online discourse. New Delhi ranked 193rd out of 200 cities.

37. India recently expanded its diplomatic presence in Central America by operationalizing a full Resident Mission in which capital?

A) Managua, Nicaragua B) San José, Costa Rica C) Tegucigalpa, Honduras D) Panama City, Panama

Answer: B) San José, Costa Rica | Explanation: Established to boost bilateral commerce, consular operations, and pharmaceutical exports with Costa Rica.

38. In October 2026, India's Ramsar wetland network expanded to 103 sites with the addition of Sau Jheel, located in which district?

A) Etawah, UP B) Mainpuri, Uttar Pradesh C) Hardoi, UP D) Kannauj, UP

Answer: B) Mainpuri, Uttar Pradesh | Explanation: Sau Jheel oxbow wetland in Mainpuri joined the Ramsar list alongside Sukhna Lake (102nd, Chandigarh).

39. What position did India hold in the Henley Passport Index (Q4 2026), granting its citizens visa-free entry to 58 nations?

A) 80th B) 84th C) 87th D) 92nd

Answer: B) 84th | Explanation: Tied with Algeria and Mauritania at 84th position. Singapore retained 1st place with visa-free access to 195 destinations.

40. In the Global Hunger Index (GHI) 2026, what rank did India receive among 122 assessed nations?

A) 94th B) 100th C) 105th D) 111th

Answer: B) 100th | Explanation: India registered an overall index score of 27.3 ("Serious" category), with child wasting remaining an area of policy concern at 18.7%.